

Nest Registration and Confirmation

Responsible STCC Members		Emergency numbers		Other numbers	
Ard Vreugdenhil	644 7970	Police & Fire	911	Rampenbestrijding	462 9111
Ingo van Veghel	665 4330	Ambulance	912	Odette Doest	566 1775
Marianne Kros (only for Banda Abou)	519 5051	Coast guard	913		
Natalia Morón	522-1661	Hyperbaric chamber	910		

Kit Checklist	Personal Checklist
○ Sample tubes (DNA & Isotope) ○ Measuring tape (long!) ○ Gloves ○ Garbage bags ○ Nylon flagging tape ○ Permanent marker ○ Nesting signs ○ Clipboard, pen ○ Mobile phone logged into EarthRanger	○ Sunscreen ○ Hat/cap ○ Long sleeves ○ Water ○ Mobile phone/camera

Turtle activity:

1. If there is no lead (leading volunteer) present, then contact the responsible STCC member of this route before you continue.
2. Take pictures from a. tracks and b. nest and c. location of the nest at different angles. It is important to see what the tracks and nests look like. The more photos the better.
3. **Start** by determining the activity type
 - a. Dry run: The turtle crawled over the beach and returned without making a body pit.
 - b. Attempt: The turtle crawled on the beach and made one or more body pits, but didn't lay eggs.
 - c. (Suspected) nest: The turtle crawled on the beach and made a body pit and covering pit (fluffy sand is visible, sharp edges from the covering pit are present).
4. Open up EarthRanger and select the event corresponding with the activity (Dry run, Attempt or Nest).

Activity ID:

Each nesting activity during the season receives a unique identifier to ensure proper tracking and data consistency. The ID is constructed as follows: **Format:** YYMMDD-BB-TYPE-#

Components:

- YYMMDD: The **date** of the activity (Year, Month, Day).
- BB: A **two-letter beach code** (see list below).
- TYPE: The **activity type**:
 - D – Dry run (false crawl)
 - A – Attempt (nesting attempt, no eggs laid)
 - UN – Unconfirmed Nest
 - CN – Confirmed Nest
 - H - Hatching
- #: **Activity number** for that day (e.g., 1 for the first activity, 2 for the second, etc.).

If the nest needs to be relocated add an **R** Behind the **Activity number**

Example: 250524-TB-A-2

→ On **May 24, 2025**, at **Turtle Beach**, an **Attempt**, the **second Activity** of the day.

250728-MB-CN-1R

→ On **July 27, 2025**, at **Mermaid Beach**, a **Confirmed nest**, the **first Activity** of the day, That is **Relocated**.

Registration of activities

Dry run:

1. Start filling in the General information
2. Determine the Activity ID **see above**.
3. Fill in the date and time, observers, location, beach continue to Activity data.
4. Determine the species by the tracks (see figure on last page).
5. Measure the crawl width in meters to the closest tenth
6. Measure the crawl length in meters to the closest tenth
7. Determine the crawl width pattern.
8. Determine the freshness, same night, 1 night, 2 nights or not to be determined.
9. Within EarthRanger Take pictures of the track in, track out and the location of the track.
10. Smooth over the tracks so it will not be double counted in nesting beach monitoring activities

Attempt:

1. Start filling in the General information
2. Determine the Activity ID **see above**.
3. Fill in the date and time, observers, location, beach continue to Activity data.
4. Determine the species by the tracks (see figure on last page).
5. Measure the crawl width in meters.
6. Measure the crawl length in meters.

7. Determine the crawl width pattern.
8. Determine the freshness, same night, 1 night, 2 nights or not to be determined.
9. Determine the number of body pits
10. Perform triangulation for the last body pit in the track by following the instructions on the **Triangulation Field Card**.
11. Within EarthRanger Take pictures of the track in, track out, body pit(s), the location of the track and the triangulation map.
12. Smooth over the tracks so it will not be double counted in nesting beach monitoring activities.

Nest:

1. Start filling in the General Information
2. Determine the Activity ID **see above**.
3. Fill in the date and time, observers, location, beach continue to Activity data.
4. Determine the species by the tracks (see figure on last page).
5. Measure the crawl width in meters.
6. Measure the crawl length in meters.
7. Determine the crawl width pattern.
8. Determine the freshness, same night, 1 night, 2 nights or not to be determined.
9. Determine the number of body pits.
10. Determine the nest type by confirming the nest (see **Nest conformation** below).
11. Measure the distance to the high water line in meters from the (suspected/confirmed) nest.
12. Determine the expected hatching date (date of that day + 60 days)
13. Perform triangulation for the location of the eggs (if it is a confirmed nest) or for the location you think the eggs should be (if it is a suspected nest) by following the instructions on the **Triangulation Field Card**.
14. Mark if the nest needs to be relocated; yes or no.
15. Within EarthRanger, take pictures of the track in, track out, body pit(s), the location of the nest, the first egg and the triangulation map.
16. Mark the nest location with a banner, nylon flagging tape and/or a sign. **If there are threats like pigs, dogs, tourist pressure etc** make sure to cover the nest with a pallet riser.
17. Remove the crawl so it will not be double counted in nesting beach monitoring activities.

Important: Do you think there is a need to relocate the nest? Consult with a responsible STCC member as soon as possible if you think that the nest needs to be relocated. Use the **Nest Relocation** field card in case of relocating the nest.

A nest needs to be relocated if:

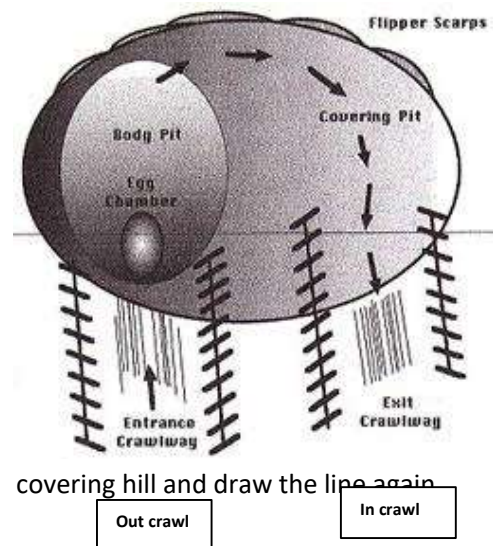
- You can see water in the nest;
- The nest is close to the water line (< 1 meter);
- The nest has been dug up;
- The nest is shallow or unprotected;
- The nest is very close to a (palm) tree (< 0.5 meter);
- Lots of clay and roots are in the nest.

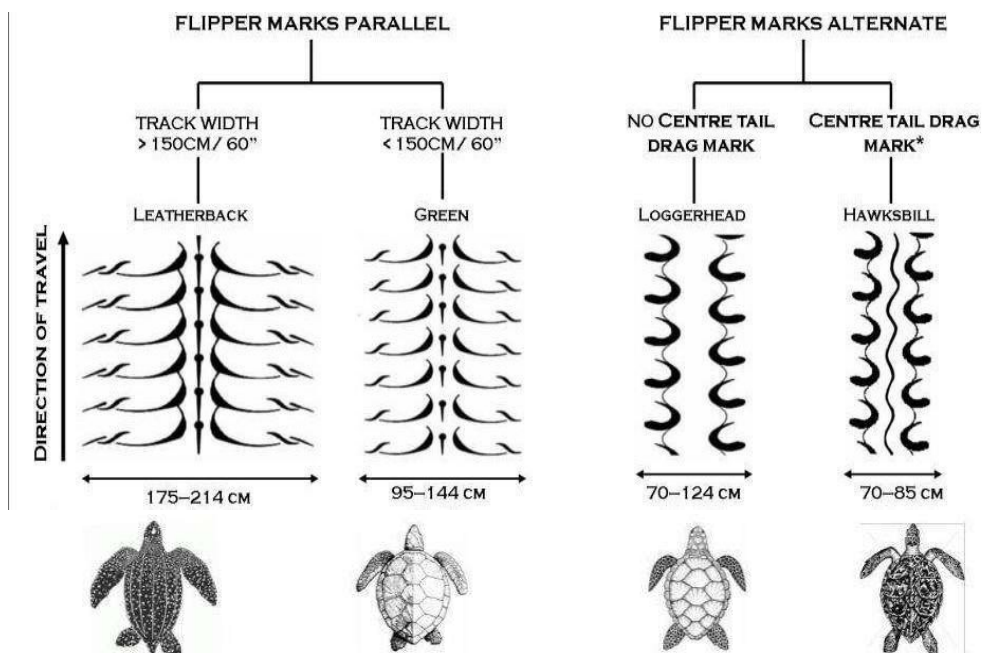
Note: If the nest needs to be relocated mark yes in EarthRanger, complete the event and continue filling out the **Relocation Event**.

Nest confirmation

A nest can either be a confirmed nest or a suspected nest. Without a visual confirmation of eggs, a site with a large amount of disturbance that appears to be a nest site is a “suspected nest”. These can be confirmed later during the hatching period. If you suspect the activity to be a nest start digging for the eggs by following this method:

- Before you start digging **put on gloves**;
- If there is a nest there must be a hill of sand behind the covering pit, we call this the covering hill. The egg chamber is located somewhere underneath the covering hill.
- Draw a line through the middle of the track (the cloaca of the turtle is always in the middle of the track).
- Place a stick at the beginning of the covering hill and at the beginning of the covering pit.
- Remove +/- 20 cm of the top layer of the between the sticks.
- Start digging every 20 cm straight down on the line till you are arm length deep, at the bottom of the hole start digging horizontal with your hand. Repeat this process over the whole line until you find the eggs.
- If you found the eggs, take a quick picture and put back the sand, you took out the latest first so you don't mix up the order. **Check if there are corals or plastics in the sand and remove them!**
- Once the egg chamber is full of sand again gently tap the sand so it becomes a little firmer.
- Add back the +/- 20 cm of sand you took off before back on top of the nest and add an extra 20 cm on top of the nest.
- In EarthRanger write down the **nest type** (confirmed or suspected).





Example of the different sea turtle tracks you can encounter.



Example of a dry run

Example of an attempt with visible egg chamber



Example of a fenced off nest



Example of the first egg